

**Parish of Gallen and Rynagh****St. Mary's, Cloghan & St. Rynagh's, Banagher**

Patrick Kiernan P.P. 057 9151338

**Parish Website:** www.cloghanbanagherparish.ie**Church Radio:** 106.6 FM**Email** newsletterstrynaghs@gmail.comNotices to be in before **6 p.m.** on Thursdays.**Parish Secretary:** Tracy Dolan - Monday or Friday 10.30 to 12.30 p.m. 086 0705801**Readings:** 26th Sunday in Ordinary Time/27th Sept. 2026**Cloghan SVP** 087 9272877**Mass Times & Anniversaries**

Sat. 26 th	6.30 p.m.	St. Rynagh's	Mary (1 st Anniv.) & Ned Kennedy & daughter Denise, Feighs. Ailis Malone, Coolfin & America (1 st Anniv.) Jimmy & Lena Moran & daughter Patsy, Cuba Avenue. Jim, Nancy, Sean Mai & Michael Regan, The Crescent.
Sat. 26 th	8 p.m.	St. Mary's	Jimmy & Mary Flynn, Castle Street. Bridget & James Christie, Castle Street. Sean Claffey and deceased family members.
Sun. 27 th	9.30 a.m.	St. Mary's	Eileen (1 st Anniv.) & Phelim (14 th Anniv.) Kerin & dec. Keenaghan & David & Sean Flynn, Kinnegad. Kerin Families.
Sun. 27 th	11 a.m.	St. Rynagh's	Gerry Kiernan (17 th Anniv.) & his parents Paddy & Roseanne. Pdraig Horan, Harbour Cross (Month's Memory) Mary Barton, West End.
Mon. 28 th	9.30 a.m.	St. Rynagh's	Special Intention – Orlagh Mae (requested by M.R.) Leo O'Kane, Wicklow (requested by B. & E.) Tom & Ann Ivory, Main Street.
Tues. 29 th	9.30 a.m.	St. Mary's	Special Intention (requested by P.G.) Bridget Burke née Devery, Athlone & Cloghan. The Faithful Departed (requested by A. M.)
Wed. 30 th	9.30 a.m.	St. Rynagh's	Lucy Larkin, Luskagh (requested by M. & P.)
Thurs. 1 st	9.30 a.m.	St. Mary's	Pdraig Horan, Harbour Cross (requested by A. & J.)
Fri. 2 nd	9.30 a.m.	St. Rynagh's	Patrick (25 th Anniv.) & Mary (20 th Anniv.), Jim & Peg Hayes, Queen St
	7 p.m.	St. Mary's	Special Intention (B. & J.) Timmy Mulhare and parents Margaret & Paddy, Cloghan. Eileen & Noel Brennan.
Sat. 3 rd	6.30 p.m.	St. Rynagh's	Pdraig Horan, Harbour Cross (requested by T. & H.) Sr. Phyllis Moran, L.S.U., Mayo.
Sat. 3 rd	8 p.m.	St. Mary's	Ellen McDonagh, Newtown, Cloghan.
Sun. 4 th	9.30 a.m.	St. Mary's	Intentions of all Parishioners and Friends of the Parish. Anna Kiernan (11 th Anniv.) and husband Hughie.
Sun. 4 th	11 a.m.	St. Rynagh's	Junie Conroy née Whyte, Galway. Mary Mulvey, Harbour Road (Month's Memory) Jack Kenny, Cuba Avenue.
			Sean Woods, Ard Abhainn (requested by M.R.) Tom Quinn, Meelick. Rose Lockett née Moran, Manchester (requested by V.L.)

Jesus Said, "I am the Resurrection and the Life".**Please pray** for the repose of the souls of Joseph (Joe) Hyland, Cuba Avenue; Sr. Phyllis Moran, L.S.U., Mayo and Athlone. May they rest in peace.**Offertory Collections:** Banagher €1,185. Cloghan €950.**Donations to the Parish:** If you wish to offer financial support to the Church our bank details are as follows:- Banagher Parochial Account **IBAN:** IE23 BOFI90165034757730. **BIC:** BOFIE2D**Cloghan Hall 50/50 weekly Draw** on Wed. nights. Envelopes available in local shops and also via Revolut 087 6822321. Your support is very much appreciated.**First Friday** celebrated on Friday 2nd Oct. **Communion Calls:** Wed. 30th Sept. – Cloghan/Banagher area. Thurs. 1st Oct. – Cloghan area. Fri. 2nd Oct. – Banagher area.**Masses** First Friday: St. Rynagh's 9.30 a.m. & St. Mary's 7 p.m.**Mass in Eliza Lodge Nursing Home** on Monday 5th Oct at 3 p.m.**The Sacrament of the Anointing of the Sick** will be celebrated at both Masses on Fri. 2nd Oct. All who are sick or recovering from illness are welcome to receive the sacrament.**Feast of St. Michael, St. Gabriel and St. Raphael, Archangels** celebrated on Tues. 29th Sept. **St. Michael** patron saint of Radiologists, the sick and paratroopers. **St. Gabriel** patron saint of tele-communications, radio and TV workers. **St. Raphael** patron saint of nurses, physicians and the blind.**Feast of St. Jerome, priest and doctor of the Church** celebrated on Wed. 30th Sept. Patron saint of librarians.**Feast of St. Thérèse of the Child Jesus, Virgin and Doctor of the Church**, celebrated on Thurs. 1st Oct. Patron saint of the missions, florists, aviators and France.**Feast of The Guardian Angels:** Celebrated on Thurs. 1st Oct. We ask the Guardian Angels to guide and protect us.**Enrolment Ceremonies****Confirmation Enrolment:** Sat. 26th Sept. St. Rynagh's N.S. 6.30 p.m. St. Mary's N.S. & Luskagh N.S. 8 p.m.**First Confession & First Holy Communion Enrolment:** Sat. 3rd Oct. St. Rynagh's N.S. 6.30 p.m. St. Mary's N.S. & Luskagh N.S. 8 p.m.**Harvest Dues for the Priests of the Parish:** Sincere thanks for your generosity and support. The Harvest Dues is lodged in a central Diocesan account and each priest in the Diocese receives a monthly allowance.**Acknowledgement:** Our family would like to express our heartfelt thanks to everyone who offered kindness, sympathy and support following the sad loss of our dad and husband Pdraig Horan. We are deeply grateful for the many messages, cards and thoughtful gestures, and to all those who attended the funeral and were there to support us. The kindness shown to our family during this difficult time has brought us great comfort and has meant more to us than we can say. As an expression of our heartfelt thanks the Holy Sacrifice of the Mass will be offered for all your intentions.**The committee of the Banagher, Cloghan and Luskagh branch of Offaly Hospice** wish to acknowledge with thanks a donation of €200 from Enda Mulhare and those associated with the car parking for the funeral of the late Annette Lynam (Cloghan). The money will be used for the benefit of palliative care patients and their families in the locality.**Chair Yoga Classes:** Suitable for Men and Women to build strength and mobility in a warm and inviting environment.

Fridays at 10.30 a.m. Cost €12.50 per session. Contact Kate on 087 6450349 to book your spot. Booking essential.

Collection for Banagher Cemetery Maintenance: All donations gratefully accepted. Please put your donation in an envelope and mark Banagher Cemetery. The envelope can be left into the Church with the Offertory Collection. Your support would be greatly appreciated.**St. Mary's Church Choir** resuming practice and new members are very welcome. Please contact The Parochial House 086 0705801.**Conversational English Classes** held every Tuesday in Crank House at 11.30 a.m. All welcome.**Progressive 25:** Luskagh Camogie Club are running a weekly Progressive 25 game every Friday at 8.30 p.m. in Luskagh Parish Hall starting Friday 25th September. All welcome.**Counselling & Psychotherapy** now available in Moate & Banagher. Support for a wide range of emotional and personal challenges. Teenagers 16+ and adults welcome. Contact Tara on 087 6931527.**A special Michael English Christmas Concert** will take place in Rathcabbin Church on Sun. 20th Dec. 2026 in aid of Rathcabbin Hall. The concert promises an evening of festive music and entertainment, with doors opening at 6.30 p.m. and the show beginning at 7.30 p.m. Tickets: €30 Contact Barbara 087 4402496 or www.michaelenglish.ie**Struggling with Debt or Having Financial Worries?** Contact MABS Tullamore for Free, Confidential and Independent advice and assistance. Phone 0818 072710 or email Offaly@mabs.ie**Book Club in Banagher** which meets every first Wed. of every month at 7 p.m. in Banagher library. It's a good thing for people to do anytime, but especially in the winter with the dark evenings, there's tea and biscuits for attendees. It's a nice way for people to get together to meet and chat. Just pop by the library or turn up on the night.**Novena to Saint Thérèse of the Child Jesus**

O little Thérèse of the Child Jesus, please pick for me a rose from the heavenly gardens and send it to me as a message of love.

O Little Flower of Jesus, ask God today to grant the favors I now place with confidence in your hands.

Saint Thérèse, help me to always believe as you did, in God's great love for me, so that I might imitate your "Little Way" each day. Amen.

(Pray this prayer, plus five Our Father's, five Hail Mary's, and five Glory Be's on five successive days).

Parish Newsletter

27 September 2026

26th SUNDAY IN ORDINARY TIME / A

There is a parable about two sons in Mt 21:28-32. When Jesus told it he was drawing near the end of his public ministry and earthly existence. He had just been to the temple in Jerusalem where, in righteous anger, he had expelled the money changers and those who were selling animals. His prophetic action was, implicitly, a condemnation of the temple authorities, whose way of acting failed to give due deference to God.

That incident was followed by the symbolic cursing of a fig-tree. It was to be understood as a symbol of the Jewish people. They bore the outward leaves of religious observance, while failing to bear the expected fruit of repentance and obedience to the word and will of God. As a result, they were cursed like the fig-tree to wither and die. The curse came to fulfilment with the destruction of Jerusalem and its temple in AD 70.

The parable of the two sons was about differing responses to Jesus and his message. According to St John Chrysostom's commentary, the two sons represented Jews and Gentiles: the former, having heard the Old Testament law and promised obedience, were disobedient, while the latter, not

having heard the Old Testament law, became obedient to Christ once they heard his message. Modern scripture scholars, however, have begun to question that interpretation. They maintain that the parable is about different responses to John the Baptist. The father represented God; the first son represented tax collectors, prostitutes, and those who were lax in the observance of the law. However, they came to obey God as a result of John the Baptist's ministry. The second son represented the chief priests and the temple authorities, those who, despite their religious profession, disobeyed God by not believing in John.

This parable is reminiscent of the one about the prodigal son in Lk 15:11-32. The younger son, who represented outcasts and sinners, started out refusing to obey his father or to work for him, but finally, following many vicissitudes, he complied. The older son, who represented the scribes and Pharisees, insisted that he had worked for and obeyed his father, but in the final analysis he turned against him as a result of envy and resentment. In the last analysis, it was the younger son, in contrast to his elder brother who ended up in a loving union with his father. ■

— Pat Collins

THE COMMUNION RITE

At the Saviour's command ...

Our Father, who art in heaven, ...

Deliver us, Lord, we pray, from every evil, ...

**For the kingdom,
the power and the glory are yours
now and for ever.**

Lord Jesus Christ, ...

Amen.

The peace of the Lord be with you always.

And with your spirit.

Lamb of God, you take away the sins ...

Behold the Lamb of God, ...

**Lord, I am not worthy
that you should enter under my roof,****but only say the word
and my soul shall be healed.****Communion Antiphon** (Cf. Ps 118:49-50)**Remember your word to your servant,****O Lord,****by which you have given me hope.****This is my comfort when I am brought low.****Prayer after Communion**

May this heavenly mystery, O Lord,

restore us in mind and body,

that we may be coheirs in glory with Christ,

to whose suffering we are united

whenever we proclaim his Death.

Who lives and reigns for ever and ever. **Amen.**

Reflection

Prayerfully consider the parable of the willing son and the rebellious son and link it with your own life.



Lesson

Our God is always one for a second chance.



Prayer

Lord, turn our hearts to you and guide us through repentance to the joy of your kingdom.

